

What Does Repentance Look Like

What is repent or repentance?

Repentance is turning from sin and the unrighteous ways of your surroundings and corrupt generation and conversion. Turning to God, listening to everything that Christ, the apostles, tells you and always moving towards sincere obedience to Christ.

The basic meaning of repentance is to turn around. It is turning from evil ways and turning to Christ and through him to God.

- 1) The decision to turn from sin and to salvation in Christ involves accepting Christ not only a savior from the penalty of sin, but also as Lord of one's life. Thus, repentance involves a change of lords - from the lordship of Satan Ephesians 2:2 to the lordship of Christ and His Word Acts 26:18*
- 2) Repentance is a free decision on the part of sinners, made possible by the enabling grace given to them as they hear and believe the gospel.*
- 3) The definition of saving faith as mere trust in Christ as Savior is wholly inadequate in the light of Christ demand for repentance. To define saving faith in a way that does not necessarily involve a radical break with sin is too dangerously distort the biblical view of redemption. Faith that includes repentance is always a condition for salvation.*
- 4) Repentance was a basic message of the Old Testament prophets, John, the Baptist, Jesus Christ and New Testament Christians. The preaching of repentance must always accompany the gospel message.*

*(Acts 3:19) says **"Repent, then and turn to God, so that your sins may be wiped out, that times of refreshing may come from the Lord"***

*(Psalm 32:5) says **"Then I acknowledged my sin to you and did not cover up my iniquity. I said, "I will confess my transgressions to the Lord." And you forgave the guilt of my sin.***

*(2 Chronicles 7:14) says **"If my people who are called by my name shall humble themselves and pray and seek my face and turn from their wicked ways; then, I will hear from heaven and forgive their sin and heal their land"***

*(Psalm 51:1-2) says **"Have mercy upon me, O God, according to your lovingkindness; according unto the multitude of thy tender mercies blot out my transgressions. Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin"***

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(1 John 1:9) says “If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness.”

I have a dollar bill. If I take this dollar bill can I go to the store and buy something with it to cost a dollar?

What if this dollar bill is old? Is the dollar bill only worth 95 cents now?

What if I get the dollar bill dirty? Is that dollar bill now worth only 86 cents?

If that dollar bill is dropped on the ground and stepped on and stomped on, is that dollar bill only worth half of what it used to be worth?

What if I take that dollar bill and after I get it dirty and after I stomp on it and after I tear it apart, is the dollar bill now worthless?

The answer is no! I can take that dollar bill back together and use it to purchase something that's worth a dollar.

You see that dollar bills worth is not in the shape it's in or how messed up. It is. The worth of the dollar bill is in who created and stands behind that dollar bill.

Many of our lives are just like that! We have been fighting our struggles a long time, gotten dirty and been messy. We have gotten stumped on and hurt. We have been torn apart by different things in life. But our worth to God, our Creator was so great that he sent his son Jesus to die on a cross to forgive us of our sins if only we repent.

No matter how worn out we are ... how dirty we are... how stomped on we have been... how torn apart our lives have become or have been... We have a loving father that not only sent his son to put us back together again... but has sent the Holy Spirit to lead us and guide us and a teach us and the counselors and to reestablish our value to God back in us through teaching us the Word of God!!!

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“Come now, let us settle the matter,” says the Lord. “Though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they are red as crimson, they shall be like wool. If you are willing and obedient, you will eat the good things of the land; but if you resist and rebel, you will be devoured by the sword.” For the mouth of the Lord has spoken.

Isaiah 1:18-20 NIV